

JOBS: DOMESTICATION INTO NORMALCY

If you want to escape the Slowlane, find wealth and freedom fast, you’ve got to dump the job. Let me repeat. Dump the damn job!

Jobs suck. I mean that generically, not targeted toward a specific job. Whether you’re an electrician or a store manager, you hold a job. Jobs suck because they’re rooted in *limited leverage* and *limited control*. Sure, you can have great job (and a fun one too!) but in the scope of wealth, they limit both leverage and control—two things desperately needed if you want wealth. Here are six sucky reasons your financial plan shouldn’t revolve around a job, the nucleus to the Slowlane.

SUCKAGE #1: TO TRADE TIME IS TO TRADE LIFE

Who taught us that trading time in exchange for money was a great idea? Why does this normalcy consistently translate into unrivaled suckage? If you’re shackled to a job, you’re engaged to a glorified exchange of your time (your life) for pieces of paper that grant you freedom. *You sell your freedom to get freedom*. Pretty stupid, huh?

Jobs suck because they ravenously consume TIME. At a job, TIME TRADE is central to how you make money. A job is the basis for that horrific 5-for-2 exchange. But let me translate that word, TIME, differently: LIFE. *In a job, you sell your life for money*. If you work, you get paid. If you don’t work, you don’t get paid. Who officiated this bloodsucking marriage?

Here is a list of common jobs and how long you have to work just to earn \$1 million. If you diligently save 10% of your earnings and stuff it under a mattress, your time to \$1 million multiplies by a factor of 10. Do you have 300 years to save your way to \$1 million?

Career/Job	Average Annual Salary	Years to EARN \$1 MM	Years to SAVE \$1 MM
Architect	\$64,000	16 years	156 years
Auto Mechanic	\$34,000	30 years	294 years
Bartender	\$16,000	61 years	625 years
Carpenter	\$37,000	27 years	270 years
Software Engineer	\$80,000	13 years	125 years
Secretary	\$38,000	27 years	263 years
Hairdresser	\$22,000	47 years	454 years
Teacher	\$46,000	22 years	217 years
Pharmacist	\$95,000	11 years	105 years
Police Officer	\$48,000	21 years	208 years
Physical Therapist	\$66,000	15 years	152 years
Veterinarian	\$72,000	14 years	139 years

Source: US Bureau of Labor Statistics, Anthony Balderrama, CareerBuilder.com. Figures rounded for simplicity.